

Amar Venugopal

PHD CANDIDATE · ECONOMICS

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Education

Stanford University

PHD ECONOMICS; PHD MINOR COMPUTER SCIENCE

Stanford, CA

Expected 2027

- Primary Advisors: Guido Imbens, Jann Spiess
- Primary Fields: Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing

Rutgers University

BS PHYSICS; MINOR IN ECONOMICS, MINOR IN MATHEMATICS

New Brunswick, NJ

2019

- Primary Advisor: Stephen Schnetzer
- Primary Field: Experimental Particle Physics
- Thesis: A Search for Charge-1/3 Vector-Like Quark Pair Production in the Fully Hadronic Mode in 13TeV pp Collisions Using CMS Data from the Large Hadron Collider

Papers

JOB MARKET PAPER

Distributional Synthetic Control for Text Outcomes with an Application to Local Government Speech.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Assessing AI Choice Prediction (with B. Douglas Bernheim, Daniel Björkegren, Michael Pollmann, and Peter Robertson).

Interpretable Causal Estimation with Text-as-Treatment.

WORKING PAPERS

Participation and Representation in Local Government Speech (with Olivia Martin). arXiv:2604.21202

Causal Estimation with Latent Textual Treatments (with Omri Feldman, Jann Spiess, and Amir Feder). arXiv:2602.15730

Causal Inference on Outcomes Learned from Text (with Iman Modarressi and Jann Spiess). arXiv:2503.00725

PUBLICATIONS

Double and Single Descent in Causal Inference with an Application to High-Dimensional Synthetic Control (with Jann Spiess and Guido Imbens). *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*. Vol. 36 (NeurIPS 2023).

Search for bottom-type, vectorlike quark pair production in a fully hadronic final state in proton-proton collisions at $\sqrt{s} = 13$ TeV (with The CMS Collaboration). 2020. *Physical Review D*. Vol. 102, Iss.11.

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

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| 2025-2027 | Data Science Scholar , Stanford Institute for Human-Centered AI |
| 2026 | B.F. Haley and E.S. Shaw Fellowship , Stanford Institute for Economics and Policy Research |
| 2025 | Outstanding TA Award , Department of Economics, Stanford University |
| 2025 | Young Scientist , 8th Lindau Nobel Meeting in Economic Sciences |
| 2024 | Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI) Google Cloud Grant , Stanford University |
| 2023 | Second Year Paper Prize , Department of Economics, Stanford University |
| 2023 | Machine Learning in Economics Summer Institute 2023 - Admitted Attendee , Center for Applied Artificial Intelligence, University of Chicago Booth School of Business |
| 2021 | Graduate Fellowship , Department of Economics, Stanford University |
| 2019 | Henry Rutgers Scholar Thesis Award , Rutgers University |
| 2017 | Phi Beta Kappa , Inductee |

Conference Presentations

Causal Estimation with Latent Textual Treatments

American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC) 2026. Salt Lake City, UT. May 2026.
AI+Science: Accelerating Discovery. Stanford University. May 2026.

Causal Inference on Outcomes Learned from Text

2026 ESIF Economics and AI+ML Meeting (ESIF-AIML2026). Cornell University. June 2026.
8th Lindau Nobel Meeting in Economic Sciences. Lindau, Germany. August 2025.
Econometrics Society World Congress 2025. Seoul, Republic of Korea. August 2025.
NBER Summer Institute 2025: Frontier Econometric Methods. Cambridge, MA. July 2025.
American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC) 2025. Detroit, MI. May 2025.
Second CAMSE-CLIMB Mini-Conference. U. California Berkeley. February 2025.

Double and Single Descent in Causal Inference with an Application to High-Dimensional Synthetic Control

NeurIPS 2023. New Orleans. December 2023.
Stanford Causal Science Conference. Stanford University. November 2023.
California Econometrics Conference. U. Washington. September 2023.
HDMetrics: Big Data, High-Dimensional Methods, and Machine Learning. U. Illinois Urbana-Champaign. April 2023.

A Search for Fully Hadronic Mode Vector-Like Quark Pair Production in 13 TeV pp Collisions using CMS Data.

April Meeting of the American Physical Society. Columbus, Ohio. April 2018.

Professional Experience

2024	Summer Intern, Economy Data Science, Roblox, Inc.	San Mateo, CA
2019-2021	Analyst, Advanced Data Analytics, BlackRock, Inc.	New York, NY

Teaching Experience

Winter '26	Teaching Assistant, Intermed. Econometrics II (Grad) Primary Instructor(s): Jann Spiess, Luigi Bocola	Stanford, CA
Fall '25	Teaching Assistant, Causality, Decision Making and Data Science (Undergrad) Primary Instructor(s): Guido Imbens, Mary Wootters	Stanford, CA
Spring '25	Teaching Assistant, Intermed. Econometrics III: Methods for Applied Econometrics (Grad) Primary Instructor(s): Guido Imbens	Stanford, CA
2018 - 2019	Committee Director, Institute for Domestic and International Affairs	New Brunswick, NJ
2017 - 2018	Rutgers University Arts & Sciences Honors Tutor, Physics, Economics, Mathematics, Statistics	New Brunswick, NJ